Business Summary: Sugar Cosmetics on Instagram

Period analysed: 19 Apr 2024 – 19 Apr 2025 · 50,000 posts · Prepared for the Marketing team

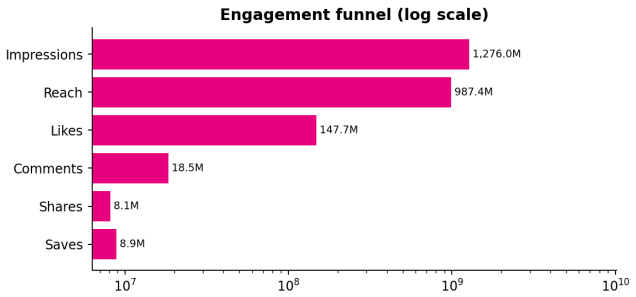
50,000	147.7M	18.5M	987M	18.5%	29.9%
Posts	Likes	Comments	Reach	Avg engagement rate	Visit-to-follow rate

The bottom line

Sugar Cosmetics' Instagram account is performing **consistently and healthily**: roughly 18.5% of the people reached interact with a post, and nearly 3 in 10 profile visitors go on to follow. The most important finding, however, is that **performance is very even**. Post format, weekday, campaign theme, hashtag and audience emotion all land within about half a percentage point of the average, and none of the differences is statistically significant (ANOVA p-values 0.15–0.57; hashtag count borderline at 0.054). In practical terms: **no single format or posting day is a magic lever**, so the biggest opportunities lie in cost efficiency, the follow journey and shareable content rather than in switching formats.

What the data shows

- **Steady cadence:** ~4,100–4,300 posts a month throughout the year (Apr-24 and Apr-25 are partial months).
- **Formats are near-identical:** Reels (18.61%) and Stories (18.60%) edge Images (18.43%) on engagement rate; Stories are weakest at driving follows (≈175 per post vs ≈179 for Images).
- **Weekdays:** Wednesday is highest (18.63%) and Sunday lowest (18.42%), a gap of only 0.2 pp. Saturday has the lowest average reach.
- **Campaigns:** Festive Offer posts trail on reach (≈19,500 vs ≈19,870 for Influencer Collab), likes and engagement rate. Tutorials convert best from profile visit to follow (30.0%).
- **Paid vs organic:** organic posts reach the most people (≈19,970 per post); paid posts reach the fewest (≈19,620), so paid is not buying extra visibility.
- **Hashtags:** #VeganBeauty (18.61%) and #BoldLooks (18.58%) lead; posts with two hashtags (18.63%) edge one hashtag (18.44%).
- **Funnel:** 77% of impressions are unique reach; of those reached, 15.0% like, 1.9% comment, 0.9% save and 0.8% share. Shares and saves, the strongest signals of intent, are the thinnest layer.



Recommendations

- **Keep a balanced format mix, lean toward Reels.** They have the top engagement rate and the most saves; use them for tutorials and launches. Treat this as a test, not a conclusion.
- **Fix the follow journey on Stories.** Add follow/profile prompts and link stickers; Stories drive the fewest follows per post.
- **Re-brief Festive Offer content.** Pair offers with Giveaway or Influencer-Collab mechanics, which achieve higher reach and likes.
- **Review paid spend.** Paid reach is not higher than organic; compare cost per follow before the next campaign flight.
- **Build for saves and shares.** Shade guides, how-to carousels and “save for later” prompts target the weakest funnel layers.
- **Use 2–3 hashtags** and rotate #VeganBeauty / #BoldLooks into core posts; avoid single-hashtag posts.

Campaign ideas aligned to the brand

- **#BoldLooksChallenge** – followers recreate a signature Sugar shade look; best creators win a giveaway (mixes UGC, reach and shares).
- **“Vegan & Cruelty-Free, Explained”** – short Reel series with a saveable ingredient card; leverages the best-performing hashtags.
- **Festive Collab Drop** – influencer-led festive offer to lift the weakest campaign type.

Data limitations & next steps

The dataset has no caption, posting time, spend or follower-count fields, and 50,000 posts in one year is far more than a single brand would publish, so the data looks aggregated or simulated and should be validated before large budget decisions. Growth is estimated from follows generated (flat at ~0.72M per full month). Recommended next step: run controlled A/B tests on one variable at a time and add cost, post time and demographic fields to future exports.

Engagement rate = (likes + comments + shares + saves) ÷ reach × 100, averaged across posts.